

## SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

# Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

| CASTE DISCRIMINATION: GANDHI AND AMBEDKAR                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
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| PHILOSOPHY OPTIONAL • PAPER II • SOCIO-POLITICAL PHILOSOPHY • TOPIC 10                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>00 The central question and conceptual grammar</b><br>CENTRAL QUESTION -> how does birth-based hierarchy reproduce itself, and how do Gandhi and Ambedkar differently seek its transformation?<br>TEXTUAL FOURFOLD ORDER (VARNA) != LIVED BIRTH-GROUP (JATI)                 | <b>01 Reproduction: endogamy to graded inequality</b><br>endogamy -> inherited membership -> hereditary status<br>-> occupational closure + purity/pollution + sanction<br>-> division of labourers -> graded inequality<br>-> fractured solidarity and restricted free association<br>TRAP -> caste is not merely work division, class or prejudice. | <b>02 Caste in democracy and the body politic</b><br>universal franchise -> political voice, representation, bargaining<br>caste power -> patronage, candidate selection, social blocs<br>ASSERTION for equal citizenship != DEFENCE of hereditary supremacy                            |
| <b>03 Gandhi's staged position</b><br>EARLIER -> idealised hereditary duty-order (varna), no asserted rank<br>CAMPAIGN -> untouchability condemned; temple entry and common service<br>LATER -> increasingly critical of birth barriers; inter-caste marriage                   | <b>04 Gandhian moral reform: argument and method</b><br>equal spiritual worth -> untouchability violates truth + non-violence (ahimsa)<br>-> privileged caste responsibility, repentance, self-purification<br>-> truth-force (satyagraha) + constructive programme + reinterpretation                                                                | <b>05 Ambedkar's caste diagnosis</b><br>Castes in India (1916) -> endogamy closes the marriage circle<br>closed circle -> caste reproduction -> status hierarchy<br>graded inequality -> each level has stake in distinction below<br>RESULT -> caste is anti-social and weakens public |
| <b>06 Annihilation rather than adjustment</b><br>Annihilation of Caste (1936) -> isolated reform leaves sanction intact<br>caste-sanctioning authority + endogamy + power must be confronted<br>inter-caste marriage attacks closure; EDUCATE -> AGITATE -> ORGANISE            | <b>07 Ambedkar's social-democratic programme</b><br>rights + remedies -> protected action<br>representation -> autonomous political voice<br>constitutional morality -> civic norms above inherited authority<br>liberty + equality + fraternity -> social democracy<br>conversion (1956) -> Buddhism as new vehicle                                  | <b>08 The Gandhi-Ambedkar matrix</b><br>TARGET: Gandhi untouchability/late barriers   Ambedkar caste itself<br>ROOT: corrupted conscience   endogamy, sanction, closure, power<br>AGENT: reformed society   autonomous oppressed organisation                                           |
| <b>09 Poona Pact and secular democracy</b><br>Communal Award (1932) -> separate electoral arrangements<br>Poona Pact (1932) -> joint electorate + reserved seats + primary-election mechanism<br>Gandhi: feared lasting separation   Ambedkar: feared dependent representatives | <b>10 Safeguards, affirmative action and legal-status discipline</b><br>Article 17 -> constitutional rule abolishing untouchability<br>1989 Act, in force 1990 -> enacted protective penal statute<br>grounds -> compensatory   distributive   representational   anti-domination                                                                     | <b>11 PYQ answer spine and qualified conclusion</b><br>DEFINE -> name the exact caste mechanism or thinker-axis<br>DISTINGUISH -> varna/jati/caste; reform/annihilation; law/social change<br>ARGUE -> named anchor -> analysis -> objection/reply -> residual limit                    |

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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# Caste Discrimination: Gandhi and Ambedkar - Solved Practice Workbook

## BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

### AUTHORED MCQ AND REMEDIATION BANK

#### Q1. Which distinction is accurate?

- A. Varna is not identical with lived jati.
- B. Jati and untouchability are synonyms.
- C. Caste means only occupation.
- D. Untouchability is the whole caste system.

**Answer: A. Varna is not identical with lived jati.**

**Explanation:** Varna is a textual classification while jati is a lived birth-based group.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not collapse the four terms.

#### Q2. Ambedkar's 'division of labourers' chiefly means:

- A. work is always unjustly divided
- B. workers are fixed and ranked by birth
- C. all occupations are identical
- D. labour has no social value

**Answer: B. workers are fixed and ranked by birth**

**Explanation:** The point is hereditary ranking and closure of persons.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not substitute a generic anti-work claim.

#### Q3. Graded inequality impedes solidarity because:

- A. only two groups exist
- B. all groups have identical interests
- C. intermediate groups can retain status over groups below
- D. law abolishes all hierarchy

**Answer: C. intermediate groups can retain status over groups below**

**Explanation:** A ladder distributes an interest in distinction.

**Trap/remediation:** Avoid a simple binary model.

#### Q4. Which is an extreme practice of caste stigma?

- A. Varna
- B. Jati
- C. Occupation
- D. Untouchability

**Answer: D. Untouchability**

**Explanation:** Untouchability names intensified exclusion.

**Trap/remediation:** It is not a synonym for caste.

#### Q5. Universal franchise can democratically enable:

- A. representation and bargaining by subordinated groups
- B. automatic social equality

- C. the disappearance of caste
- D. only caste supremacy

**Answer: A. representation and bargaining by subordinated groups**

**Explanation:** Equal votes can create political voice.

**Trap/remediation:** Political equality is not social transformation.

**Q6. Caste should be related to class and gender as:**

- A. identical to both
- B. interacting but not reducible to either
- C. unrelated to either
- D. a biological category

**Answer: B. interacting but not reducible to either**

**Explanation:** Land, labour, gender and endogamy interact with caste.

**Trap/remediation:** Avoid reductionism.

**Q7. A defensible assessment of caste political assertion is that it:**

- A. is always anti-democratic
- B. is always emancipatory
- C. must be judged by programme and effect
- D. has no relation to equality

**Answer: C. must be judged by programme and effect**

**Explanation:** Assertion can seek equal voice or defend hierarchy.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not equate identity with supremacy.

**Q8. Endogamy links caste and gender principally through:**

- A. electoral voting
- B. taxation
- C. religious pluralism
- D. regulation of marriage and sexuality

**Answer: D. regulation of marriage and sexuality**

**Explanation:** Marriage closure reproduces caste membership.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not treat gender as an afterthought.

**Q9. Gandhi's earlier idealised varna was presented as:**

- A. hereditary duty without asserted superiority
- B. abolition of all birth allocation
- C. a defence of untouchability
- D. identical with jati

**Answer: A. hereditary duty without asserted superiority**

**Explanation:** This is why Gandhi must be periodised.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not erase the early liability.

**Q10. The term 'Harijan' should be handled as:**

- A. a neutral current self-description
- B. historical usage later rejected by many Dalit thinkers

- C. a constitutional category
- D. Ambedkar's preferred term

**Answer: B. historical usage later rejected by many Dalit thinkers**

**Explanation:** It requires a historical and contested-term note.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not present it as uncontested.

**Q11. Gandhi's later trajectory became increasingly supportive of:**

- A. separate electorates
- B. hereditary occupation
- C. inter-caste marriage and critique of birth barriers
- D. caste supremacy

**Answer: C. inter-caste marriage and critique of birth barriers**

**Explanation:** The owner requires a staged account.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not make Gandhi static.

**Q12. The central theoretical liability of idealised hereditary varna is:**

- A. it rejects all duty
- B. it abolishes work
- C. it guarantees equality
- D. birth allocation can preserve closure despite denied rank

**Answer: D. birth allocation can preserve closure despite denied rank**

**Explanation:** No declared superiority does not remove inherited assignment.

**Trap/remediation:** Rank and allocation are distinct issues.

**Q13. For Gandhi, untouchability violates:**

- A. truth, ahimsa and equal spiritual worth
- B. only electoral procedure
- C. economic calculation alone
- D. constitutional morality alone

**Answer: A. truth, ahimsa and equal spiritual worth**

**Explanation:** His argument is moral-religious.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not replace Gandhi's language with Ambedkar's.

**Q14. Which best describes Gandhi's method?**

- A. violent class conflict
- B. self-purification, satyagraha and constructive work
- C. reservation alone
- D. separate electorates alone

**Answer: B. self-purification, satyagraha and constructive work**

**Explanation:** His method joins moral and social practice.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not reduce it to private piety.

**Q15. The structural objection to Gandhi is that:**

- A. he opposed all reform
- B. law never matters

- C. heart-change can leave power and representation intact
- D. fraternity is irrelevant

**Answer: C. heart-change can leave power and representation intact**

**Explanation:** The objection concerns dependency on goodwill.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not caricature Gandhi.

**Q16. A fair Gandhian reply to the structural objection is that:**

- A. rights are unnecessary
- B. hierarchy is natural
- C. caste is only class
- D. constructive practice and moral responsibility change social relations

**Answer: D. constructive practice and moral responsibility change social relations**

**Explanation:** The reply is real but not complete.

**Trap/remediation:** Keep the residual need for safeguards.

**Q17. In Ambedkar's account, endogamy is:**

- A. a central mechanism of caste reproduction
- B. an irrelevant private choice
- C. a sufficient legal remedy
- D. a synonym for untouchability

**Answer: A. a central mechanism of caste reproduction**

**Explanation:** Closed marriage circles transmit group boundaries.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not call it the whole explanation.

**Q18. Graded inequality means:**

- A. equal ranks for all groups
- B. a hierarchy in which each level may be above some and below others
- C. economic class only
- D. a temporary electoral alliance

**Answer: B. a hierarchy in which each level may be above some and below others**

**Explanation:** It explains fractured solidarity.

**Trap/remediation:** Avoid binary language.

**Q19. Caste is anti-social for Ambedkar because it:**

- A. creates all cultural difference
- B. prevents voting
- C. institutionalises unequal status and restricted association
- D. requires no social sanction

**Answer: C. institutionalises unequal status and restricted association**

**Explanation:** Plurality differs from ranked separation.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not condemn diversity as such.

**Q20. Castes in India is dated:**

- A. 1932
- B. 1936

C. 1956

D. 1916

**Answer: D. 1916**

**Explanation:** The owner dates the endogamy analysis to 1916.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not confuse it with *Annihilation of Caste*.

**Q21. Annihilation of Caste argues that:**

A. reforming practice while retaining sanction is insufficient

B. untouchability alone is the issue

C. inter-dining is always sufficient

D. political rights are irrelevant

**Answer: A. reforming practice while retaining sanction is insufficient**

**Explanation:** The normative foundation and reproduction mechanisms must be confronted.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not make annihilation a slogan.

**Q22. Which remedy most directly attacks endogamy?**

A. temple entry alone

B. inter-caste marriage

C. a single election

D. a legal definition alone

**Answer: B. inter-caste marriage**

**Explanation:** Marriage across closed groups attacks reproduction of caste.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not treat it as the only remedy.

**Q23. Education, organisation and self-respect are best understood as:**

A. individual charity

B. a replacement for rights

C. a politics of collective emancipation and voice

D. proof that caste is over

**Answer: C. a politics of collective emancipation and voice**

**Explanation:** They build agency and representation.

**Trap/remediation:** Avoid self-help reduction.

**Q24. Ambedkar's target in rejecting caste-sanctioning authority is:**

A. individual believers as such

B. all freedom of conscience

C. only economics

D. authority used to impose hereditary civic inferiority

**Answer: D. authority used to impose hereditary civic inferiority**

**Explanation:** The claim is about social authority and equal citizenship.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not misstate it as hostility to persons.

**Q25. For Ambedkar, fraternity is:**

A. the social basis that sustains liberty and equality

B. a decorative feeling unrelated to democracy

- C. opposed to rights
- D. identical with charity

**Answer: A. the social basis that sustains liberty and equality**

**Explanation:** It makes equal associated living possible.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not sentimentalise it.

**Q26. Constitutional morality chiefly requires:**

- A. blind obedience to social custom
- B. placing civic equality above inherited social authority
- C. abolishing all institutions
- D. only periodic voting

**Answer: B. placing civic equality above inherited social authority**

**Explanation:** It restrains hierarchy through constitutional norms.

**Trap/remediation:** It is not automatic.

**Q27. Ambedkar's conversion to Buddhism in the owner is dated:**

- A. 1916
- B. 1932
- C. 1956
- D. 1990

**Answer: C. 1956**

**Explanation:** Conversion is ethical reconstruction around equality and fraternity.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not call it ritual change alone.

**Q28. Which is NOT an adequate summary of Ambedkar?**

- A. theorist of social democracy
- B. advocate of representation
- C. critic of graded inequality
- D. theorist of reservation alone

**Answer: D. theorist of reservation alone**

**Explanation:** Reservation is a safeguard in a wider programme.

**Trap/remediation:** Never reduce his doctrine to quotas.

**Q29. The Poona Pact followed:**

- A. the 1932 Communal Award's separate electoral arrangements
- B. the 1956 conversion
- C. the 1992 judgment
- D. the 2019 amendment

**Answer: A. the 1932 Communal Award's separate electoral arrangements**

**Explanation:** The Pact belongs to the representation dispute of 1932.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not detach event from issue.

**Q30. The Poona Pact substituted separate electorates with:**

- A. abolition of representation
- B. reserved seats in joint electorates with a primary-election mechanism



- C. universal adult franchise immediately
- D. a constitutional amendment

**Answer: B. reserved seats in joint electorates with a primary-election mechanism**

**Explanation:** It also increased reserved seats according to the owner.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not invent numbers.

**Q31. Ambedkar's worry about joint electorates was that:**

- A. religion would disappear
- B. all caste would end
- C. representatives could depend on dominant-caste votes
- D. law would become unnecessary

**Answer: C. representatives could depend on dominant-caste votes**

**Explanation:** The issue is autonomous political voice.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not narrate it as mere seat arithmetic.

**Q32. A sound description of the Pact is:**

- A. a harmonious consensus without pressure
- B. a dispute only about personalities
- C. proof Gandhi and Ambedkar agreed on caste
- D. a compromise reached in morally and politically coercive circumstances

**Answer: D. a compromise reached in morally and politically coercive circumstances**

**Explanation:** The context and autonomy issue must be retained.

**Trap/remediation:** Avoid celebratory narration.

**Q33. Gandhi's secular-democratic emphasis is best captured by:**

- A. equal regard, conscience and non-violence
- B. scriptural rank as civic law
- C. separate legal citizenship
- D. economic class alone

**Answer: A. equal regard, conscience and non-violence**

**Explanation:** This is distinct from Ambedkar's institutional test.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not collapse their foundations.

**Q34. Ambedkar's secular-democratic test is:**

- A. majority religious authority
- B. equal citizenship free from religiously sanctioned hierarchy
- C. absence of all ethics
- D. private charity

**Answer: B. equal citizenship free from religiously sanctioned hierarchy**

**Explanation:** No doctrine may make civic inferiority legitimate.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not make it merely state hostility to religion.

**Q35. Article 17 is correctly described as:**

- A. a judgment
- B. a commission report

- C. a constitutional rule abolishing untouchability
- D. proof discrimination disappeared

**Answer: C. a constitutional rule abolishing untouchability**

**Explanation:** Its existence does not establish social transformation.

**Trap/remediation:** Law and effect are distinct.

**Q36. The SC/ST Prevention of Atrocities Act is:**

- A. a constitutional amendment
- B. a commission report
- C. a judicial doctrine
- D. an enacted protective penal statute of 1989, in force in 1990

**Answer: D. an enacted protective penal statute of 1989, in force in 1990**

**Explanation:** Type and date matter.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not call it constitutional text.

**Q37. A compensatory justification of affirmative action focuses on:**

- A. rectifying transmitted group-directed exclusion
- B. rewarding guilt of every present individual
- C. abolishing merit
- D. religious conversion

**Answer: A. rectifying transmitted group-directed exclusion**

**Explanation:** The argument concerns continuing advantage/disadvantage, not personal guilt.

**Trap/remediation:** Use 'advantage, not guilt'.

**Q38. A representational justification principally asks whether:**

- A. past harm can never be repaired
- B. institutions include groups whose interests they govern
- C. everyone has identical income
- D. law replaces morality

**Answer: B. institutions include groups whose interests they govern**

**Explanation:** Presence and responsiveness concern democratic legitimacy.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not merge it with compensation.

**Q39. The strongest merit-proxy reply says:**

- A. merit has no value
- B. exams always measure capacity perfectly
- C. exam performance is a proxy affected by unequal access
- D. all outcomes should be identical

**Answer: C. exam performance is a proxy affected by unequal access**

**Explanation:** It contests the measurement of merit, not role competence.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not deny merit.

**Q40. A genuine remaining concern about group remedies is:**

- A. all historical harm is imaginary
- B. rights never matter

- C. representation automatically secures response
- D. over-inclusion and uneven incidence of cost

**Answer: D. over-inclusion and uneven incidence of cost**

**Explanation:** A strong answer concedes the residual design problem.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not pretend the objection vanishes.

**Q41. The Mandal Commission is correctly classified as:**

- A. a commission appointed in 1979 that reported in 1980
- B. a 1992 Supreme Court judgment
- C. a 2019 constitutional amendment
- D. a 1989 penal statute

**Answer: A. a commission appointed in 1979 that reported in 1980**

**Explanation:** A commission recommends; it does not enact.

**Trap/remediation:** Instrument type is examinable.

**Q42. Indra Sawhney (1992) is:**

- A. a statute
- B. a Supreme Court judgment on OBC reservation in central services under Article 16(4)
- C. a constitutional amendment
- D. a commission report

**Answer: B. a Supreme Court judgment on OBC reservation in central services under Article 16(4)**

**Explanation:** The owner also states creamy-layer exclusion and the ordinary 50-percent rule.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not extend its holding to later measures.

**Q43. The 103rd Amendment (2019) is:**

- A. a judgment
- B. a commission report
- C. an enabling amendment inserting Articles 15(6) and 16(6)
- D. a penal statute

**Answer: C. an enabling amendment inserting Articles 15(6) and 16(6)**

**Explanation:** It enables special provision, including up to ten percent for specified EWS categories.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not say it directly creates every reservation.

**Q44. Janhit Abhiyan (2022) is identified in the owner as:**

- A. a commission report
- B. a statute abolishing caste
- C. a constitutional amendment
- D. a Supreme Court judgment upholding the amendment by majority

**Answer: D. a Supreme Court judgment upholding the amendment by majority**

**Explanation:** It is a legal illustration, not philosophical proof.

**Trap/remediation:** Keep law and justification distinct.

**Q45. Which final verdict best fits a Gandhi-Ambedkar comparison?**

- A. Rights and structure are necessary; moral transformation must serve, not replace, them.
- B. Conscience alone guarantees equality.

- C. Law alone creates fraternity.
- D. The thinkers differed only in tone.

**Answer: A. Rights and structure are necessary; moral transformation must serve, not replace, them.**

**Explanation:** It preserves substantive disagreement while retaining a role for moral change.

**Trap/remediation:** Avoid false complementarity.

**Q46. For a 20-marker comparison, the best organisation is:**

- A. two biographies in sequence
- B. a common-axis grid followed by adjudication
- C. only legal provisions
- D. only a Poona Pact narrative

**Answer: B. a common-axis grid followed by adjudication**

**Explanation:** Shared axes make the philosophical difference visible.

**Trap/remediation:** Structure itself earns marks.

**Q47. Which is the safest quotation discipline?**

- A. Put all key terms in quotation marks.
- B. Attribute any memorable phrase without a source.
- C. Teach doctrines as doctrines unless a verified edition/page supports a quote.
- D. Invent exact dates for Gandhi's shifts.

**Answer: C. Teach doctrines as doctrines unless a verified edition/page supports a quote.**

**Explanation:** The owner is not a critical edition.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not fabricate quotations.

**Q48. Which distinction closes a strong answer?**

- A. Caste is only the past.
- B. All law is futile.
- C. Moral reform is irrelevant.
- D. Enactment, enforcement and social transformation are distinct stages.

**Answer: D. Enactment, enforcement and social transformation are distinct stages.**

**Explanation:** The conclusion links safeguards to unfinished social democracy.

**Trap/remediation:** Do not infer social change from a legal instrument.

## PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

### VERIFIED PYQS WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

### PYQ 1 - 2018 · Q1(c) (10 marks)

**Question:** It is said that the traditional hold of caste-based groups on Indian social behaviour has survived all attempts to build alternate identities. Discuss in the light of M. K. Gandhi.

**Thesis / opening:** Gandhi recognised that political freedom cannot replace reform of the everyday social relations through which caste persists.

**Model answer structure:**

- Periodise Gandhi: earlier idealised varna, anti-untouchability campaign, later greater criticism of birth barriers.
- Explain untouchability as a moral-religious wrong against truth and ahimsa.
- Use repentance, self-purification, constructive work and satyagraha as mechanisms of social reform.
- Qualify: inherited allocation and autonomous oppressed voice remain unresolved by conscience alone.

**Conclusion:** Gandhi explains why social conduct needs moral transformation, but lasting equal status also requires rights and autonomous representation.

**Why this earns marks:** It answers the exact demand through a clear claim, named doctrine or evidence, analysis, qualification and a direct concluding verdict.

### PYQ 2 - 2019 · Q4(a) (20 marks)

**Question:** Examine whether there is any difference between the views of Mahatma Gandhi and Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar on the philosophical foundations of secular democracy.

**Thesis / opening:** They share opposition to civic degradation but found secular democracy differently: Gandhi in equal religious regard and conscience, Ambedkar in equal citizenship against religiously sanctioned hierarchy.

**Model answer structure:**

- Compare target, root cause, reforming agent, method, religion, representation and democracy in parallel.
- Gandhi: non-violence, conscience, fellowship and reform from within.
- Ambedkar: constitutional morality, rights, representation and social democracy.
- Explain why no community doctrine may create civic inferiority.
- Give paternalism and legalism objections with replies, then a qualified verdict.

**Conclusion:** Gandhi supplies an ethic of coexistence; Ambedkar supplies the institutional test of equal civic standing.

**Why this earns marks:** It answers the exact demand through a clear claim, named doctrine or evidence, analysis, qualification and a direct concluding verdict.

### PYQ 3 - 2020 · Q3(a) (20 marks)

**Question:** State and examine B.R. Ambedkar's contribution towards social changes in Independent India.

**Thesis / opening:** Ambedkar's contribution joins constitutional safeguards to a wider project of annihilating graded social status.

**Model answer structure:**

- Diagnose caste through endogamy, social closure and graded inequality.
- Explain rights, remedies, representation and constitutional morality as protections against social majorities.
- Develop liberty, equality and fraternity as social democracy.
- Add education, organisation, self-respect, conversion and economic independence.
- Use Article 17 as a constitutional illustration, not proof of completed social change.

**Conclusion:** His contribution is not reservation alone: it seeks a transformation from formal political equality to equal social standing.

**Why this earns marks:** It answers the exact demand through a clear claim, named doctrine or evidence, analysis, qualification and a direct concluding verdict.

### PYQ 4 - 2021 · Q4(a) (20 marks)

**Question:** Discuss the views of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar regarding caste-discrimination in Indian society. What are the measures suggested by him for its elimination? Explain.

**Thesis / opening:** For Ambedkar, caste is graded inequality reproduced by endogamy, authority and power; eliminating untouchability alone therefore cannot suffice.

**Model answer structure:**

- Explain endogamy and division of labourers.
- Reconstruct annihilation: challenge caste-sanctioning authority and inter-caste marriage.
- Set out education, organisation, self-respect, rights and representation.
- Explain constitutional morality, fraternity and social democracy.
- Treat conversion as ethical-social reconstruction and state the limit of legal action.

**Conclusion:** The measures form an integrated programme of autonomous equality, not a list of welfare concessions.

**Why this earns marks:** It answers the exact demand through a clear claim, named doctrine or evidence, analysis, qualification and a direct concluding verdict.

### PYQ 5 - 2022 · Q1(b) (10 marks)

**Question:** In the age of individualism and universal franchise, what role does caste play in body-politic? Discuss.

**Thesis / opening:** Universal franchise creates equal political status, but caste can still organise social power, representation and mobilisation.

**Model answer structure:**

- State the franchise/social-hierarchy distinction.
- Show representation and bargaining as democratic possibilities.
- Show candidate selection, patronage and social blocs as persistence mechanisms.
- Distinguish oppressed assertion from caste supremacy and give a qualified verdict.

**Conclusion:** Caste is politically ambivalent: it may voice historic exclusion yet cannot itself dissolve graded social status.

**Why this earns marks:** It answers the exact demand through a clear claim, named doctrine or evidence, analysis, qualification and a direct concluding verdict.

### PYQ 6 - 2022 · Q2(b) (15 marks)

**Question:** Critically evaluate Gandhi's views on eradication of caste discrimination.

**Thesis / opening:** Gandhi's moral mobilisation against untouchability is indispensable, but reform dependent on dominant conscience is structurally insecure.

**Model answer structure:**

- Periodise varna, anti-untouchability and later movement.
- Explain ahimsa, repentance, satyagraha and constructive programme.
- Credit his mass moral intervention and privileged-caste responsibility.
- Assess paternalism, varna and structural-power objections with fair replies.
- Conclude that moral change must supplement enforceable equality and voice.

**Conclusion:** Gandhi remains ethically significant, but cannot substitute for the institutional transformation demanded by equal citizenship.

**Why this earns marks:** It answers the exact demand through a clear claim, named doctrine or evidence, analysis, qualification and a direct concluding verdict.

**PYQ 7 - 2023 · Q3(b) (15 marks)**

**Question:** Critically analyse the social and political significance of Ambedkar's notion of annihilation of caste.

**Thesis / opening:** Annihilation is socially significant because it makes fraternity and association possible, and politically significant because it makes representation and equal citizenship real.

**Model answer structure:**

- Trace caste sanction, endogamy and graded inequality.
- Explain why reform of untouchability alone leaves the foundation intact.
- Social significance: free association, inter-caste kinship and fraternity.
- Political significance: autonomous organisation, rights, representation and social democracy.
- Raise legalism/state-competence limits and reply through the wider programme.

**Conclusion:** The doctrine seeks abolition of hereditary valuation, not merely adjustment of access to offices.

**Why this earns marks:** It answers the exact demand through a clear claim, named doctrine or evidence, analysis, qualification and a direct concluding verdict.

**PYQ 8 - 2024 · Q1(c) (10 marks)**

**Question:** Discuss the main factors responsible for caste discrimination.

**Thesis / opening:** Caste discrimination is reproduced through mutually reinforcing marriage closure, inherited rank, occupational restriction, ritual sanction and power.

**Model answer structure:**

- Differentiate varna, jati, caste and untouchability.
- Explain endogamy, hereditary status and occupational closure.
- Add purity-pollution, religious sanction, economic dependence and social violence.
- Use graded inequality to explain durability and finish with a structural verdict.

**Conclusion:** The factors form a reproducing system; no single cultural or economic factor explains caste discrimination alone.

**Why this earns marks:** It answers the exact demand through a clear claim, named doctrine or evidence, analysis, qualification and a direct concluding verdict.



### PYQ 9 - 2025 · Q2(a) (20 marks)

**Question:** Present a detailed account of the debate between Gandhi and Ambedkar on the issue of caste discrimination.

**Thesis / opening:** Both condemn untouchability, but Gandhi principally seeks moral-religious reform while Ambedkar diagnoses caste itself as a structure requiring annihilation and autonomous power.

**Model answer structure:**

- Use the seven-axis comparison: target, varna/caste, root mechanism, agent, method, religion, democracy.
- Interpret Poona Pact as conflict over representative autonomy, not seat arithmetic.
- Contrast heart-change with rights and institutional power.
- Add secular democracy, constitutional morality and fraternity.
- Adjudicate paternalism and legalism, ending with a qualified structural verdict.

**Conclusion:** The strongest synthesis is Ambedkarite in rights and structure, while retaining moral transformation as a necessary but non-substituting condition.

**Why this earns marks:** It answers the exact demand through a clear claim, named doctrine or evidence, analysis, qualification and a direct concluding verdict.

## ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

### Original Mains 1 - 10 marks · 150 words

**Question:** Explain why Ambedkar's distinction between a division of labour and a division of labourers is central to a philosophical account of caste discrimination.

**Model solution:**

- Claim: a functional allocation of tasks need not rank persons or fix them by birth.
- Named evidence: Ambedkar's caste diagnosis joins hereditary status, endogamy and social closure.
- Analysis: caste assigns occupation and worth to workers, restricts mobility and fractures association through graded inequality.
- Qualification: endogamy is central but must be paired with ritual authority and material power.
- Verdict: the distinction explains why abolition requires equal social standing, not merely occupational reform.

### Original Mains 2 - 15 marks · 220 words

**Question:** Critically assess the claim that Gandhian moral reform and Ambedkarite constitutional safeguards are mutually necessary for the eradication of caste discrimination.

**Model solution:**

- Define the question as a non-substitution problem: moral change and enforceable equality do different work.
- Gandhi: anti-untouchability, repentance, constructive practice and the responsibility of privileged castes.
- Ambedkar: endogamy, graded inequality, representation, constitutional morality and social democracy.
- Objection to Gandhi: paternalism and powerlessness; reply: law cannot manufacture fellowship.
- Objection to Ambedkar: legalism; reply: his programme includes fraternity, education, organisation and conversion.
- Verdict: safeguards must be structurally prior, while moral reform is indispensable only as their social realisation.

### Original Mains 3 - 20 marks · 300 words

**Question:** Does affirmative action answer Ambedkar's critique of caste, or only mitigate one consequence of it? Discuss with reference to representation, merit and social democracy.

**Model solution:**

- Thesis: affirmative action is a necessary safeguard for access and representation, but it cannot by itself annihilate the valuation of persons that caste creates.
- Name four grounds: compensatory, distributive, representational and anti-domination; select representation plus anti-domination as the leading frame.
- Explain the reverse-discrimination objection fairly, then reply through unequal production of examination proxies and continuing advantage rather than personal guilt.
- Concede over-inclusion and uneven incidence; explain the philosophical purpose and cost of internal filters.
- Use one typed illustration-Article 17, *Indra Sawhney*, or the 103rd Amendment-without treating it as philosophical proof.
- Return to Ambedkar: endogamy, fraternity, constitutional morality, organisation and conversion exceed access to positions.
- Verdict: safeguards mitigate exclusion and redistribute power; social democracy requires the deeper transformation of inherited status.

### Answer-specific execution and compression upgrades

These controls follow the detailed models and make each one executable in the timed paper.

### PYQ 1 - 2018 · Q1(c) (10 marks) - timed-paper upgrade

**Directive and demand decoding:** The operative demand is **the stated directive**. Address this exact question: *It is said that the traditional hold of caste-based groups on Indian social behaviour has survived all attempts to build alternate identities. Discuss in the light of M. K. Gandhi.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

**How to improve this answer:** State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *It is said that the traditional hold of caste-based groups on Indian social behaviour has survived all attempts to build alternate identities. Discuss in the light of M. K. Gandhi.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

**Executable exam-length/compression guidance:** 150 words: verdict-led definition, three analytical moves, one precise qualification and a direct close. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

### PYQ 2 - 2019 · Q4(a) (20 marks) - timed-paper upgrade

**Directive and demand decoding:** The operative demand is **Examine**. Address this exact question: *Examine whether there is any difference between the views of Mahatma Gandhi and Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar on the philosophical foundations of secular democracy.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

**How to improve this answer:** State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Examine whether there is any difference between the views of Mahatma Gandhi and Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar on the philosophical foundations of secular democracy.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

**Executable exam-length/compression guidance:** about 300 words: thesis, six developed moves, named comparison, strongest objection/reply, India-linked application where relevant and a graded conclusion. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

### PYQ 3 - 2020 · Q3(a) (20 marks) - timed-paper upgrade

**Directive and demand decoding:** The operative demand is **State**. Address this exact question: *State and examine B.R. Ambedkar's contribution towards social changes in Independent India.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

**How to improve this answer:** State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *State and examine B.R. Ambedkar's contribution towards social changes in Independent India.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

**Executable exam-length/compression guidance:** about 300 words: thesis, six developed moves, named comparison, strongest objection/reply, India-linked application where relevant and a graded conclusion. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

#### PYQ 4 - 2021 · Q4(a) (20 marks) - timed-paper upgrade

**Directive and demand decoding:** The operative demand is **Discuss**. Address this exact question: *Discuss the views of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar regarding caste-discrimination in Indian society. What are the measures suggested by him for its elimination? Explain.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

**How to improve this answer:** State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Discuss the views of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar regarding caste-discrimination in Indian society. What are the measures suggested by him for its elimination? Explain.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

**Executable exam-length/compression guidance:** about 300 words: thesis, six developed moves, named comparison, strongest objection/reply, India-linked application where relevant and a graded conclusion. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

#### PYQ 5 - 2022 · Q1(b) (10 marks) - timed-paper upgrade

**Directive and demand decoding:** The operative demand is **the stated directive**. Address this exact question: *In the age of individualism and universal franchise, what role does caste play in body-politic? Discuss.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

**How to improve this answer:** State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *In the age of individualism and universal franchise, what role does caste play in body-politic? Discuss.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

**Executable exam-length/compression guidance:** 150 words: verdict-led definition, three analytical moves, one precise qualification and a direct close. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

#### PYQ 6 - 2022 · Q2(b) (15 marks) - timed-paper upgrade

**Directive and demand decoding:** The operative demand is **Critically evaluate**. Address this exact question: *Critically evaluate Gandhi's views on eradication of caste discrimination.* Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

**How to improve this answer:** State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Critically evaluate Gandhi's views on eradication of caste discrimination.* rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

**Executable exam-length/compression guidance:** 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

### PYQ 7 - 2023 · Q3(b) (15 marks) - timed-paper upgrade

**Directive and demand decoding:** The operative demand is **the stated directive**. Address this exact question: *Critically analyse the social and political significance of Ambedkar's notion of annihilation of caste*. Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

**How to improve this answer:** State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Critically analyse the social and political significance of Ambedkar's notion of annihilation of caste*. rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

**Executable exam-length/compression guidance:** 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

### PYQ 8 - 2024 · Q1(c) (10 marks) - timed-paper upgrade

**Directive and demand decoding:** The operative demand is **Discuss**. Address this exact question: *Discuss the main factors responsible for caste discrimination*. Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

**How to improve this answer:** State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Discuss the main factors responsible for caste discrimination*. rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

**Executable exam-length/compression guidance:** 150 words: verdict-led definition, three analytical moves, one precise qualification and a direct close. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

### PYQ 9 - 2025 · Q2(a) (20 marks) - timed-paper upgrade

**Directive and demand decoding:** The operative demand is **Present**. Address this exact question: *Present a detailed account of the debate between Gandhi and Ambedkar on the issue of caste discrimination*. Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

**How to improve this answer:** State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Present a detailed account of the debate between Gandhi and Ambedkar on the issue of caste discrimination*. rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

**Executable exam-length/compression guidance:** about 300 words: thesis, six developed moves, named comparison, strongest objection/reply, India-linked application where relevant and a graded conclusion. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

### Original Mains 1 - 10 marks · 150 words - timed-paper upgrade

**Directive and demand decoding:** The operative demand is **Explain**. Address this exact question: *Explain why Ambedkar's distinction between a division of labour and a division of labourers is central to a philosophical account of caste discrimination*. Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

**How to improve this answer:** State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Explain why Ambedkar's distinction between a division of labour and a division of labourers is central to a philosophical account of caste discrimination*. rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

**Executable exam-length/compression guidance:** 150 words: verdict-led definition, three analytical moves, one precise qualification and a direct close. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

### Original Mains 2 - 15 marks · 220 words - timed-paper upgrade

**Directive and demand decoding:** The operative demand is **the stated directive**. Address this exact question: *Critically assess the claim that Gandhian moral reform and Ambedkarite constitutional safeguards are mutually necessary for the eradication of caste discrimination*. Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

**How to improve this answer:** State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Critically assess the claim that Gandhian moral reform and Ambedkarite constitutional safeguards are mutually necessary for the eradication of caste discrimination*. rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

**Executable exam-length/compression guidance:** 220-250 words: thesis, four or five claim-evidence-analysis moves, one objection/reply and a qualified verdict. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.

### Original Mains 3 - 20 marks · 300 words - timed-paper upgrade

**Directive and demand decoding:** The operative demand is **Does**. Address this exact question: *Does affirmative action answer Ambedkar's critique of caste, or only mitigate one consequence of it? Discuss with reference to representation, merit and social democracy*. Do not replace it with a general topic summary.

**How to improve this answer:** State the conclusion in the opening; turn each major claim into **claim -> named thinker/text/example -> analysis -> qualification**; preserve the model's strongest objection and reply; and make the final sentence answer *Does affirmative action answer Ambedkar's critique of caste, or only mitigate one consequence of it? Discuss with reference to representation, merit and social democracy*. rather than merely repeat the doctrine.

**Executable exam-length/compression guidance:** about 300 words: thesis, six developed moves, named comparison, strongest objection/reply, India-linked application where relevant and a graded conclusion. Cut decorative biography and repeated definitions first; never cut the governing distinction, named evidence, objection or verdict.